Bihar Museum Biennale 2025
Global South: Sharing Histories

BIENNALE BEYOND BORDERS

The third edition of Bihar Museum Biennale stitches together heritage, art, and memory, tracing the living connections that bind the Global South across oceans and generations. In doing so, it becomes a living archive of creativity and collective memory...



The monsoon skies outside seemed to mirror the mood inside the Bihar Museum, Patna—a sense of cordiality, shared experiences, and the promise of continuity—as **Chief Minister Nitish Kumar stepped forward to inaugurate the third Bihar Museum Biennale (BMB-III) on the evening of 7 August 2025.**

The event's logo, inspired by the concept of the **Tree of Life**, featured tree whose roots and branches spanned three continents, its form uniting the African baobab, the Asian peepal, and the colours and textures of South America. It succinctly captured the Biennale's theme—Global South: Sharing Histories—bringing together artists, thinkers, and institutions from across Asia, Africa, and Latin America.

Flanked by Deputy Chief Ministers Samrat Choudhary and Vijay Kumar Sinha, and joined by the Minister of Art, Culture and Youth Moti Lal Prasad, the Chief Minister's presence underscored the earnestness of Bihar's cultural aspirations. He interacted with ambassadors, artists, curators, and scholars from Indonesia, Ethiopia, Sri Lanka, Mexico, Argentina, and Peru, who looked on as the Biennale opened its doors to exhibitions, performances, and conversations to be carried over all through 2025 and beyond.

The spirit of the Biennale had already spilled onto the streets the day before, with a heritage walk on 6 August linking the Patna Museum on Buddha Marg to the Bihar Museum on Nehru Path. Over six hundred participants—students in crisp uniforms, young professionals with cameras slung over their shoulders, heritage activists carrying placards with messages such as **"Dharohar Hamari Kya Maange – Thoda Samman, Thoda Pyar, Puri Safai"**—wove through the streets as a pre-event for the Bihar Museum Biennale 2025. It was a public procession reclaiming history, inviting citizens to see the museums not as static buildings but as living spaces of identity and pride.

Prior to that, the curtain raiser of the Biennale took place from June 3 to June 18, 2025 comprising two exhibitions from the National Museum of Australia that set significant precedents for the study of indigenous cultural traditions and the effects of colonial development on traditional communities. These exhibitions– **"Evolution: Torres Strait**